

Seneca

POLYTECHNIC

Program Overview

Entrepreneurship Work Integrated Learning (EWIL) Program

Session One

Agenda

1:00 PM - Class Introductions

1:15 PM - HELIX Overview (Genesis, Launch, Catalyst Fund)

1:25 PM - EWIL Overview (Expectations, Outcomes, Semester Schedule)

1:35 PM - Week 1 Ideation

1. Innovator's Mindset
2. Idea vs Business Idea
3. Business Pillars
4. Ideation
5. Vision & Mission Statement

2:00 PM - Break

2:55 PM - Q&A

3:00 PM - Networking



Introductions

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Sundar Manku

Manager, Entrepreneurship Programs



Suhitha Srinivasamoorthy

Associate Manager, Entrepreneurship
Initiatives

**Name, Program, Venture Idea,
Optional Fun Fact!**

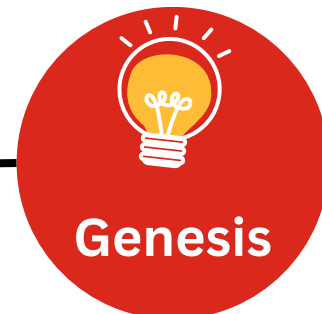


HELIX Overview



EWIL

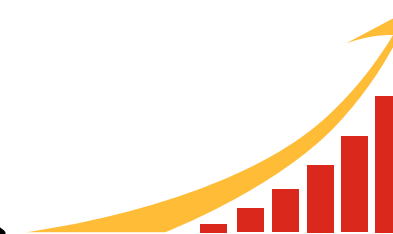
13-week Work Integrated Learning Program.



6-week bootcamp to help you develop and think of a business idea!



Entrepreneurs



Launch

Develop 6 deliverables with your assigned coach and meet on a weekly basis to take your business to the next level.



Catalyst Fund

Pitch for up to \$4,500 in the form of a micro-grant.



Program Outcomes

Through the next 13-weeks you will go over the following topics:

- Ideation
 - Strategic Thinking
 - Prototyping & Validation
 - Marketing
 - Sales
- People Resources
 - Legal Aspects & Finances
 - Investment-Readiness
 - Pitching
 - Business Planning
 - Pivoting & Exit Strategy
 - Presentation Week



Program Outcomes

You will have developed the skills necessary to create a viable business and the ability to effectively communicate your ideas.

Three main objectives:

- Find an idea
- Develop a prototype
- Secure your first client



Program Outcomes

- **Develop entrepreneurial management and growth techniques** through strategic plans and product validation research to prepare for product launch
- **Gain knowledge of educational resources** to support entrepreneurial growth
- **Develop knowledge about key challenges** facing an entrepreneur at different stages in the growth cycle



Program Outcomes

- **Understand different tools/models that can be used to minimize risk** at different stages of the entrepreneurial journey
- **Identify possible funding** sources, streams and/or structures that could be applied to your business



Deliverables

First 6 Weeks

- Weekly word doc.
- A workbook follows each Module - 6 workbooks in total.
- PMReady Certificate - First 6 Modules on the Xperienced platform.

Week 7 to 13

- Weekly word doc.
- Pitch Deck

Final Deliverable is a 5-minute pitch followed by 3-min of Q&A in the week of **December 7th**.



Coaching

- Bi-weekly coaching sessions in groups of up to 11
- Session timing is based on a coach's availability
- The meeting duration is 60 minutes
- Each student delivers their elevator pitch and provides an update on their progress and next 2-week goals

Session objectives: Create measurable results throughout the program

Warning: Missing any coaching sessions will result in removal from the program



5 Main Components

- 30 Second Elevator Pitch
- Last Weeks Goal
- Progress/Challenges
- Next Weeks Goal
- Your Ask to Us (for the next 2 weeks)



EWIL Overview



Hello everyone, my business _____ Business Name _____ focuses on
_____ Problem Statement _____ by _____ Solution _____

Last week our goal was to _____ Last weeks goal _____

During this time, we managed to _____ Current progress/update _____

These next two weeks we are trying to _____ Next two week goal _____

I need help with _____ The Ask for the next two weeks _____



Select Your Coach



Due TODAY



Huayi (Ed) Gao
Fridays from 3 pm to 4pm - Starts next week



Thanusshan Thayalakumaran
Tuesdays from 5 pm to 6 pm - Starts next week



Leonardo Moura
Tuesdays from 4 pm to 5 pm [TBD] - Starts next week [in-person]



Ali Nasser
Thursdays from 10 am to 11 am - Starts next week

Program Schedule

Month	Month 1				
Day	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
Week 1		EWIL 1-3 PM	Working Day - EWIL	Weekly Coaching	Working Day - EWIL
Week 2	Deliverables Due at 11:59 PM	EWIL 1-3 PM Research Session 3-4 PM	Working Day - EWIL	Weekly Coaching	Working Day - EWIL
Week 3	Deliverables Due at 11:59 PM	EWIL 1-3 PM	Working Day - EWIL	Weekly Coaching	Working Day - EWIL

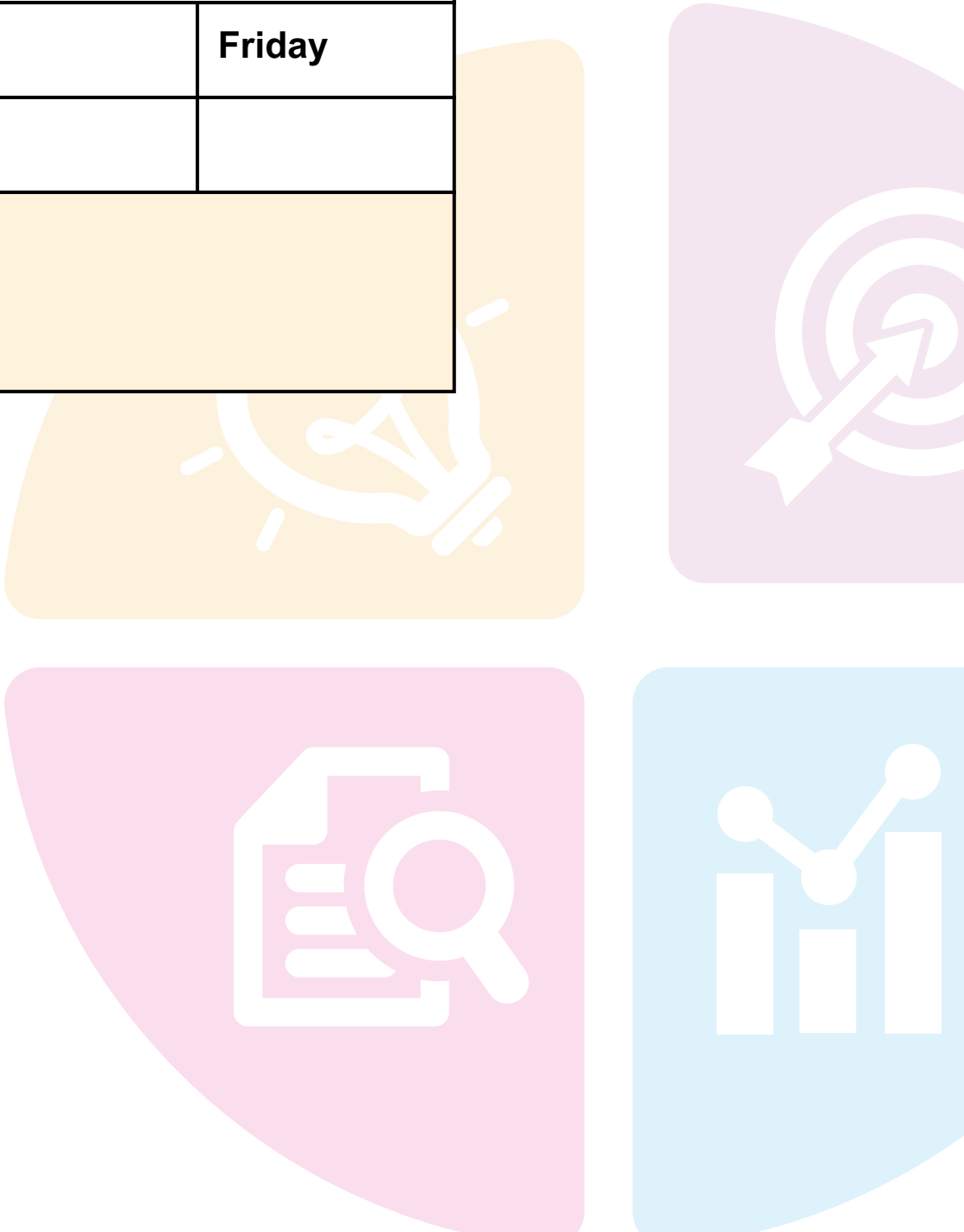
Program Schedule



Month	Month 2				
	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
Week 4	Deliverables Due at 11:59 PM	EWIL 1-3 PM Base44 Session 3-4 PM	Working Day - EWIL	Weekly Coaching	Working Day - EWIL
Week 5	Deliverables Due at 11:59 PM		Working Day - EWIL	EWIL 1-3 PM	Working Day - EWIL
Week 6	Deliverables Due at 11:59 PM	EWIL 1-3 PM	Working Day - EWIL	Weekly Coaching	Working Day - EWIL
Week 7	Deliverables Due at 11:59 PM	EWIL 1-3 PM	Working Day - EWIL	Weekly Coaching	Working Day - EWIL

Program Schedule

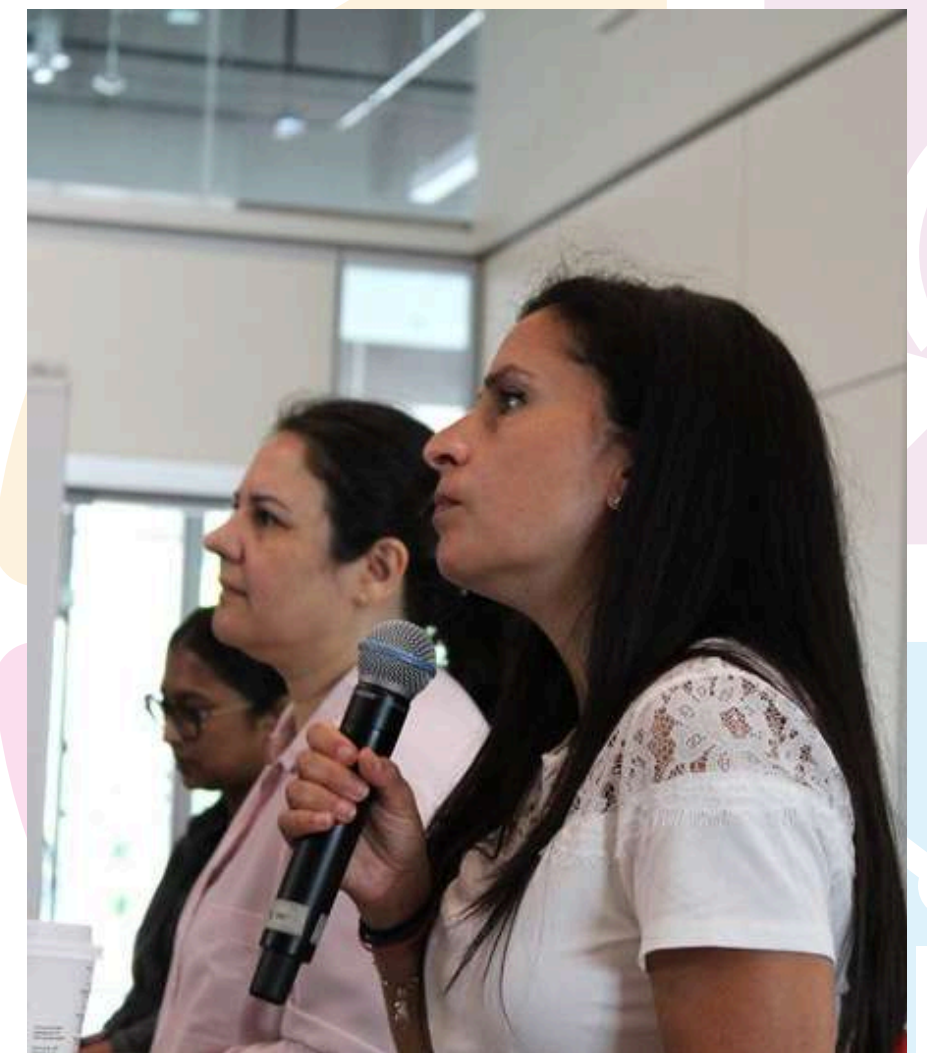
Month	Month 4				
Day	Monday	Tuesday	Wednesday	Thursday	Friday
Week 13	Pitch Week				



Program Schedule

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Final Pitch Day



Program Schedule

Speaker Session



SME Summit & Small Business Show



Fall 2024



Summer 2025



Fall 2025



SME Summit & Small Business Show



Summer 2026



Class Trip

Seneca
POLYTECHNIC

Small Business Show



smesummit.ca

Seneca
Seneca HELIX
POLYTECHNIC



Tuesday, October 13, 2026

Order your free ticket today



PMI PMReady Certification Process

Fall 2026

PMReady Overview



Project Management Ready (PMR) Certification

Seneca Student Federation

Offered by the [Project Management Institute](#), the PMR credential is highly sought by employers, no matter which program you are in or the career you choose.

PMI Project Management Ready gives students exposure to the concepts and field of project management and the tools to apply this knowledge to a wide range of career paths.

Upon successful completion of the PMR exam, you will earn a digital badge in addition to an official certificate. These can be displayed prominently on your resume, LinkedIn profile, and other social media channels.

Process Overview

This document is a step-by-step on how to obtain your PMReady certification.

1. XperienceED

a. Learning modules/Course

2. GMetrix

a. Practice Test

3. Certiport

a. Register for Certification

4. PMReady Exam

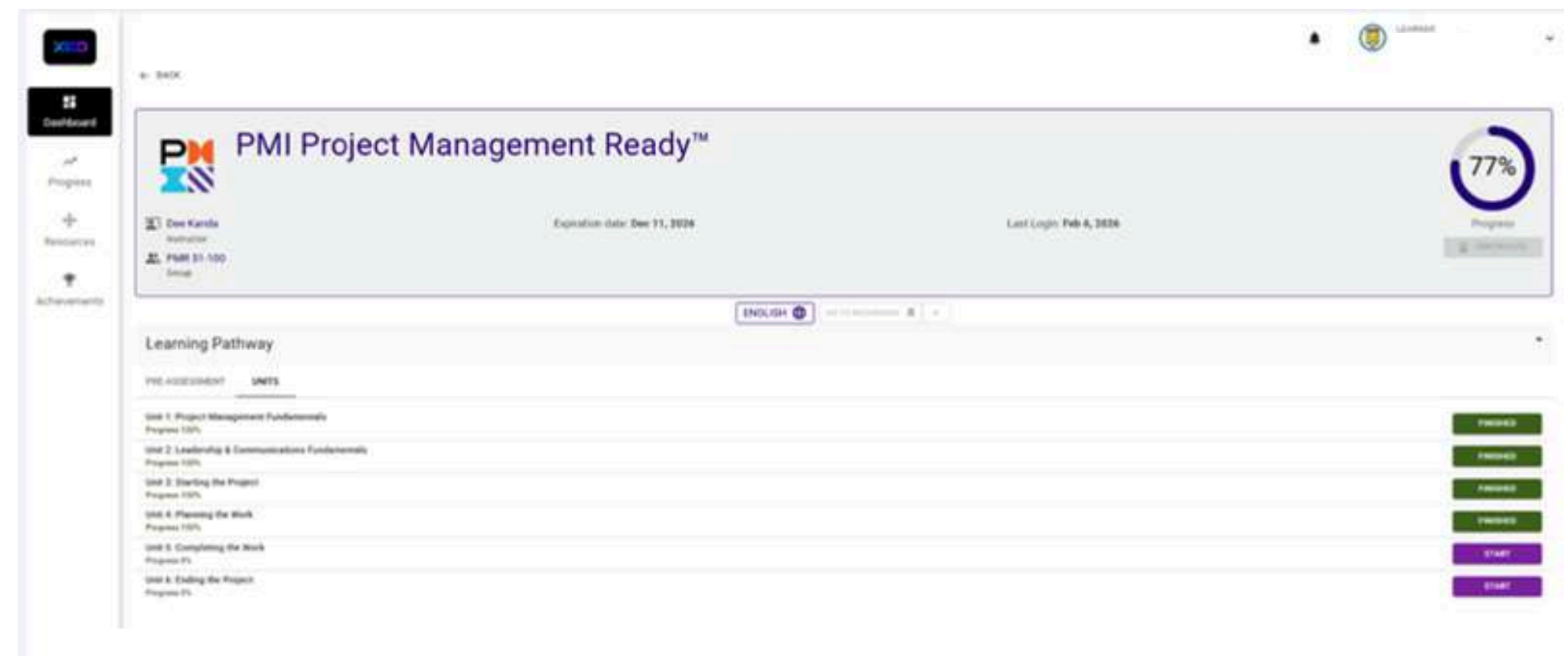
Certification Process

XperienceED

The XperienceED platform is where you will sign up to take the Project Management Course. The course contains all of the materials you will be tested on.

1. Go to <https://xperienceed.com/register>
2. Enter the Group Code

**Submit
Screenshots**



GMetrix

The GMetrix platform is where you will be able to write the practice exam. You will have unlimited attempts.

1. Go to www.gmetrix.net and
 - a. click 'No account? Sign up'
 - b. Watch this orientation video - <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=qQinb7Mftao>
2. Complete the form using your Seneca email address (student number not required).
3. Sign in to GMetrix and click Next on all the help boxes.
4. Copy and paste the access code into the box and click Redeem Code.
5. Click Next on all help boxes.
6. Select Project Management Ready. THIS IS NOT THE ACTUAL EXAM.

Certiport

You will receive your certification through the Certiport platform. You will need to create an account before taking the exam.

1. Please create your [Certiport](https://certiport.pearsonvue.com/) student account.
 - a. <https://certiport.pearsonvue.com/>

Certification Process

Exam

1. Go to [Select Date](#) or follow the link below to choose a date for the exam.
 - a. <https://forms.gle/RRtw5HoXMeGme6FXA>

PLEASE NOTE - MORE EXAM DATES TO BE ADDED

Certification Process

For support with anything PMReady related, please email:

Tirth Parsana
tirth.parsana@ssfinc.ca

Week 1 - Ideation

1. Innovator's Mindset
2. Idea vs Business Idea
3. Business Pillars
4. Ideation
5. Vision & Mission Statement



Class Question

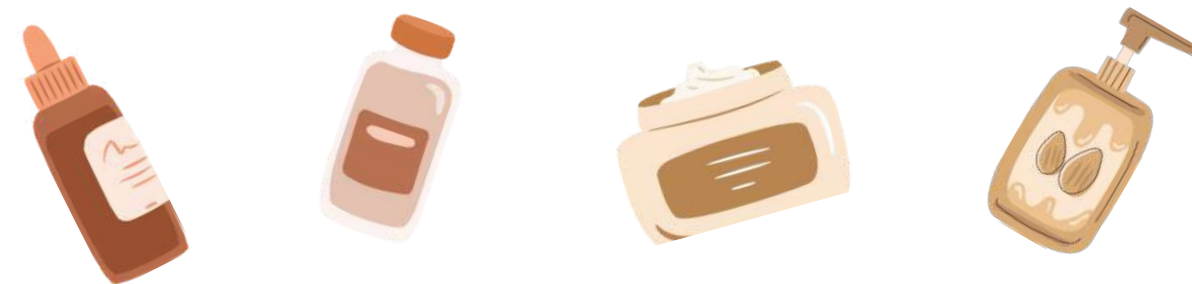
**What is Entrepreneurship?
And, how would you define
an Entrepreneur?**





Entrepreneurship is....

The process of identifying **opportunities**,
evaluating **risk**, and creating **value**.



Class Question

**What kind of skills do Entrepreneurs
need and develop?**



Entrepreneurs are unique in the way they **start**, **develop**, and **grow** their business

There are a number paths to take! You can start a...

Side Hustle



Small Business



Large Distributor



Tech Start-up



Agency



“Not Every Student Will Become an Entrepreneur. But They Will All Someday Need To Think Like One.”

-John Spencer



Entrepreneurship

In a rapidly changing world, adaptability, creativity, and problem-solving skills are crucial for success. Whether students invent companies or reinvent their own roles, an entrepreneurial mindset prepares them to thrive.



There are also different types of entrepreneurs!



Social Entrepreneurs

A social entrepreneur is a person who pursues novel applications that have the aim of solving social/community-based problems or effecting social change.

These individuals are willing to take on the risk and effort to create positive changes in society through their initiatives.

Social entrepreneurs may believe that this practice is a way to connect you to your life's purpose, help others find theirs, and make a difference in the world.



Social Entrepreneurs

The logo for TOMS is centered within a graphic consisting of three horizontal bars. The top and bottom bars are light blue, and the middle bar is light yellow. The word "TOMS" is written in a large, bold, black, sans-serif font across the middle yellow bar.

TOMS

Social Entrepreneurs



Social Entrepreneurs



Class Activity - 5 Min

Find one example of an entrepreneur from your field of study/industry and briefly describe their journey.

Intrapreneurs

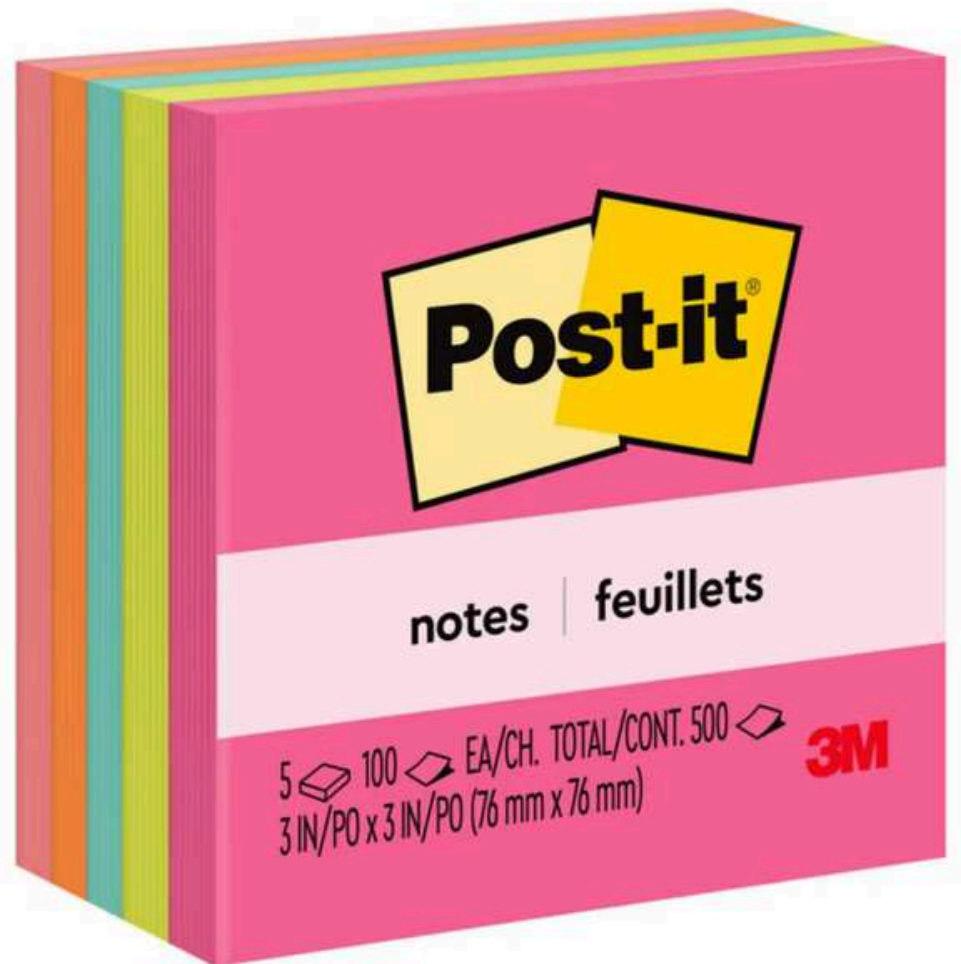
An intrapreneur is an employee who is tasked with developing an innovative idea or project within a company.

The intrapreneur may not face the outsized risks or reap the outsized rewards of an entrepreneur; however, the intrapreneur has access to the resources and capabilities of an established company.





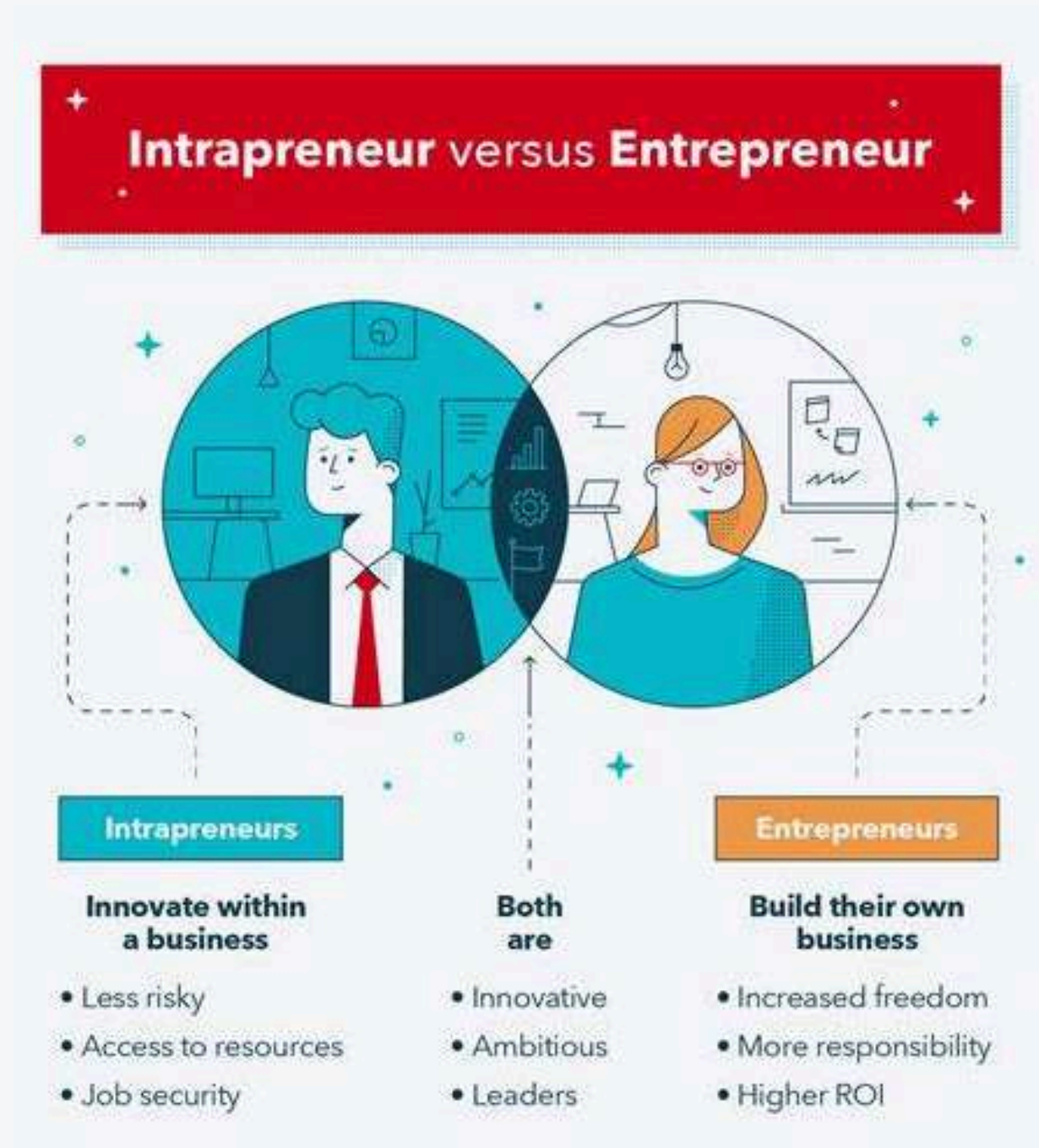
Gmail



Intrapreneurship



Intrapreneurship



Class Question

**Why do we study
Entrepreneurship?**

Why do we study Entrepreneurship?

- Failing to plan is planning to fail
- The success of smaller firms tends to be limited by factors such as inadequate management, shortages of capital, government regulation and paperwork, and lack of proper recordkeeping.
- Two other concerns are poorly planned growth and the threat of failure.

Poorly Planned Growth

- Setting goals without realistic steps to meet them.
- Not training your employees well-enough so that you are unable to delegate responsibilities.
- Not preparing for emergencies.
- Being unable to deal with stress.
- Failure to seek help.
- The paradox itself: You own your business, yet you don't enjoy it.
- Too much was left to chance
- Too many decisions were based on a hunch or intuition
- Crucial obstacles went unnoticed for too long
- The amount of time and/or physical effort was not recognized and/or planned for
- The amount of capital needed was either not estimated or grossly underestimated

Setting S.M.A.R.T. Goals

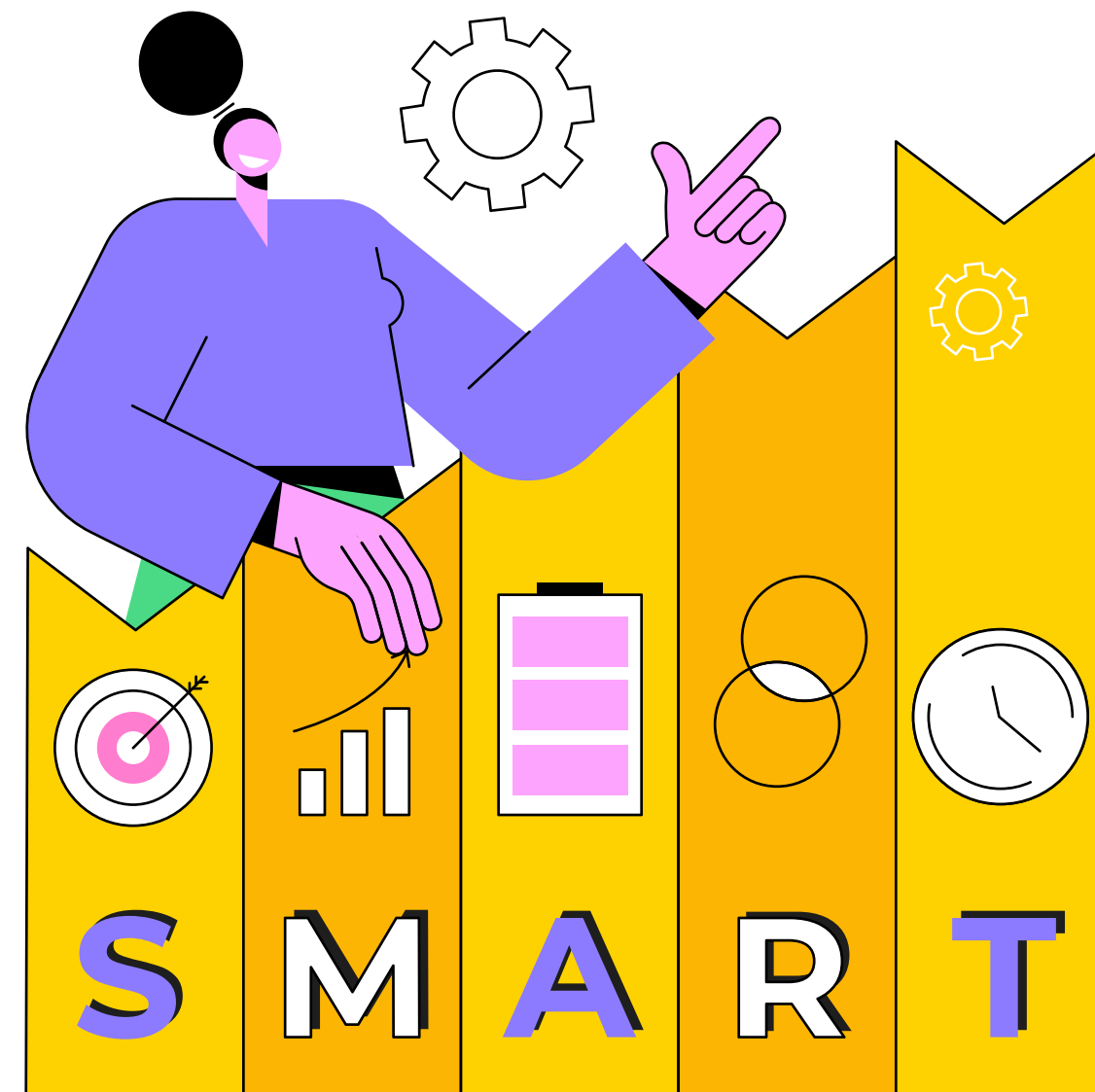
Specific

Measurable

Achievable

Relevant

Time-bound



Distinguishing between Entrepreneurial Ventures and Small Businesses

Small business

Independently owned and operated and is not dominant in its field.

Entrepreneurial venture

The principal objectives of the owner are profitability and growth.

Distinguishing between Entrepreneurial Ventures and Small Businesses

Small business Owner

Establishes a business primarily to further personal goals, including making a profit.

Entrepreneur

Goals include achievement, profit, and growth, achieved through innovation and strategic management.

**When was the last time you
shopped at a small business? Why?**



WELLER PHARMACY

Service you need from neighbours you trust!

VS

SHOPPERS
DRUG MART





vs



Why are small businesses so important?

- Encourage innovation and flexibility.
- Keep larger firms competitive
- Develop risk takers
- Generate new employment
- Maintain close relationships with customers and the community

How many small businesses are there in Canada?

Hint: there are 1.23 million employer businesses in total (Key Small Business Statistics - 2020, Government of Canada)

- 500,000
- 1,200,000
- 900,000
- 50,000

How many small businesses are there in Canada?

Hint: there are 1.23 million employer businesses in total (Key Small Business Statistics - 2020, Government of Canada)

- 500,000
- 1,200,000  (97.9% of all employer businesses are small businesses)
- 900,000
- 50,000

Most of the small businesses in Canada are located in:

- Quebec
- British Columbia
- Ontario
- Alberta

Most of the small businesses in Canada are located in:

- Quebec
- British Columbia
- Ontario  (440,306 out of 1,200,571)
- Alberta

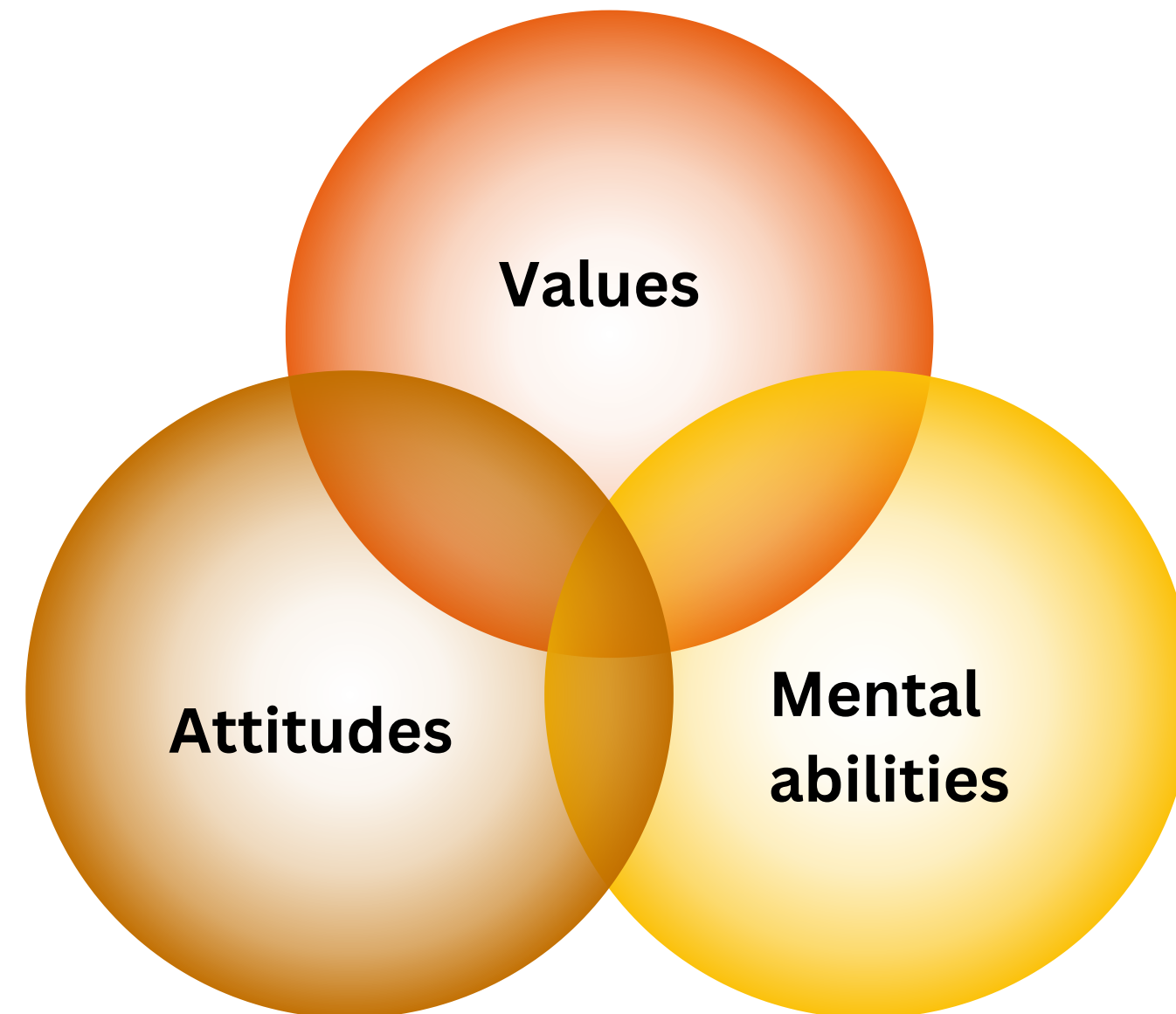
Some Current Problems Facing Small Businesses

- Political and economic issues.
- World economy.
- Capital or financing issues.
- Unexpected growth.
- Exploding technology (Hubspot, Salesforce, robots, other complex systems)

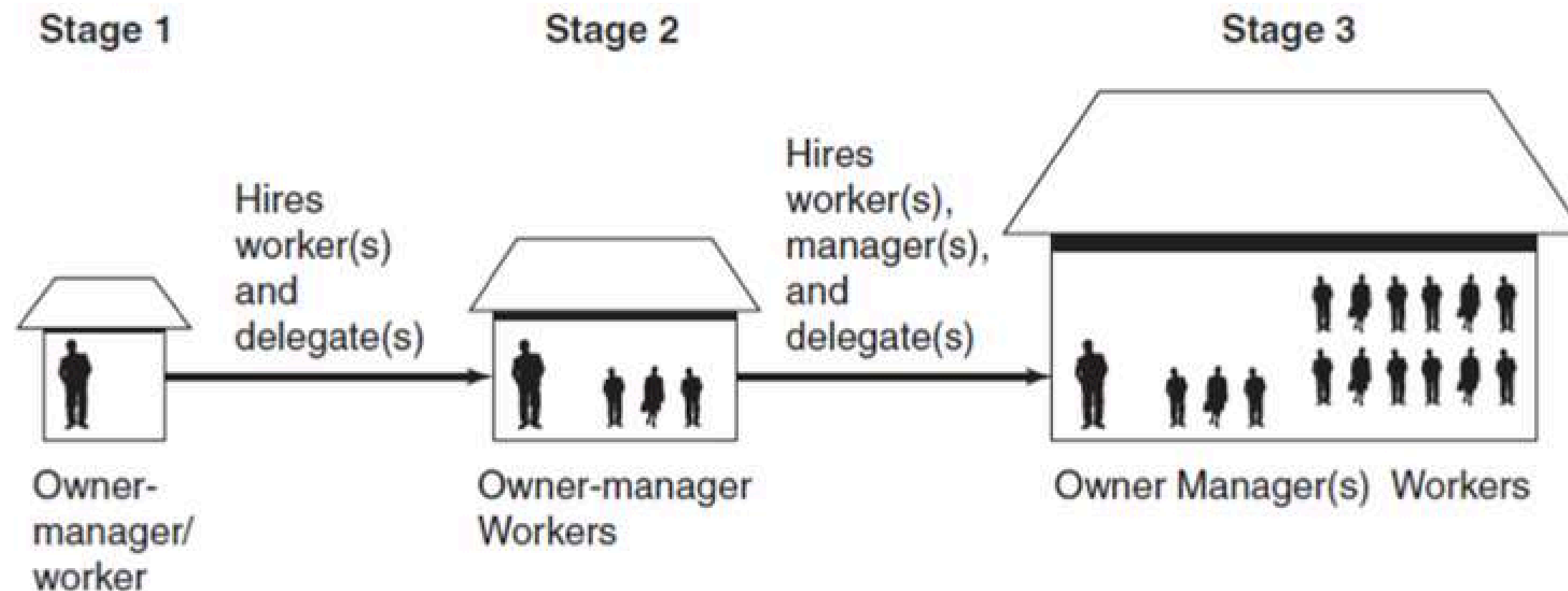
What Leads to Success in Managing a Business?

- Serving an adequate and well-defined market for the product.
- Acquiring sufficient capital.
- Recruiting and using human resources effectively.
- Obtaining and using timely information.
- Coping effectively with government regulations.
- Having expertise in the field on the part of both the owner and the employees.
- Being flexible.

Doing an Introspective Personal Analysis



Stages in the Development of a Business



Classification of business by size

Under 20 employees

Very Small

20-99

Small

100-499

Medium

500 or more

Large



WELLER PHARMACY

Service you need from neighbours you trust!

VS

SHOPPERS
DRUG MART





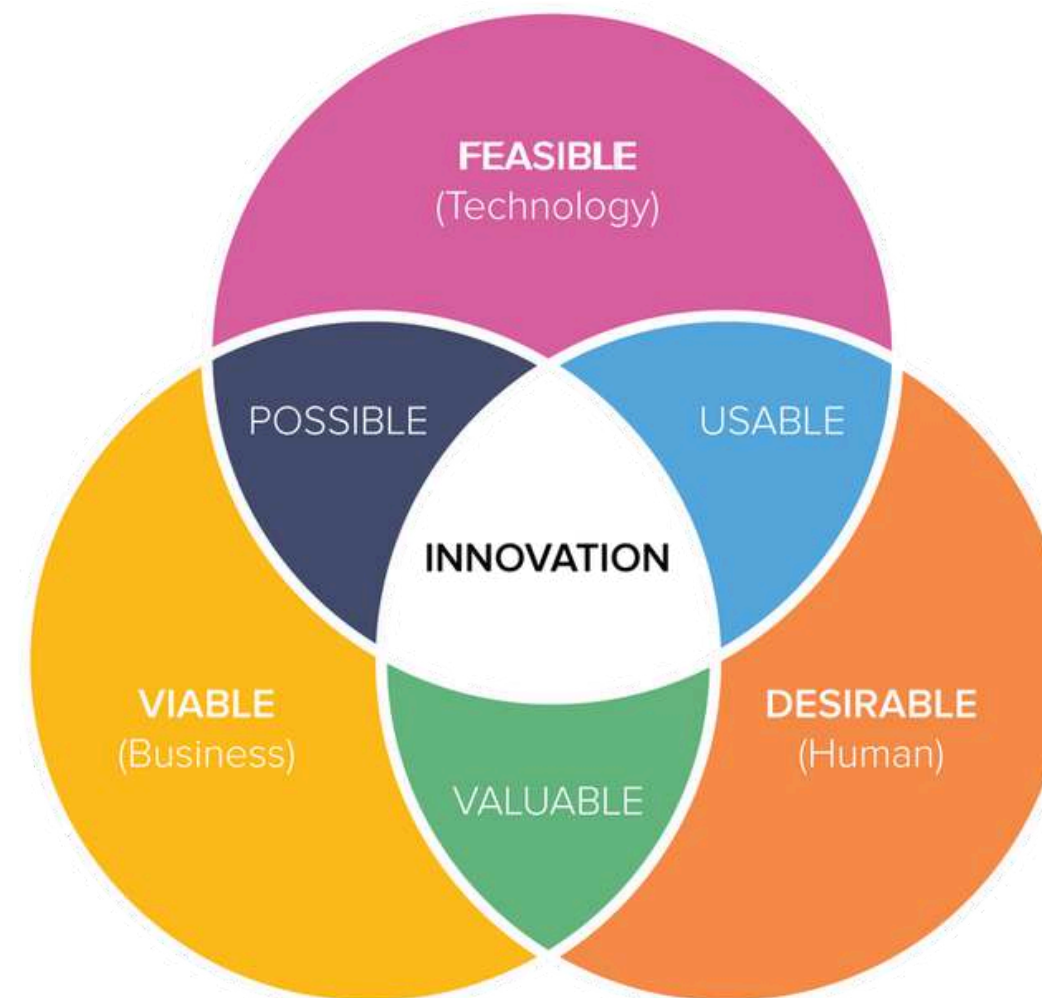
vs



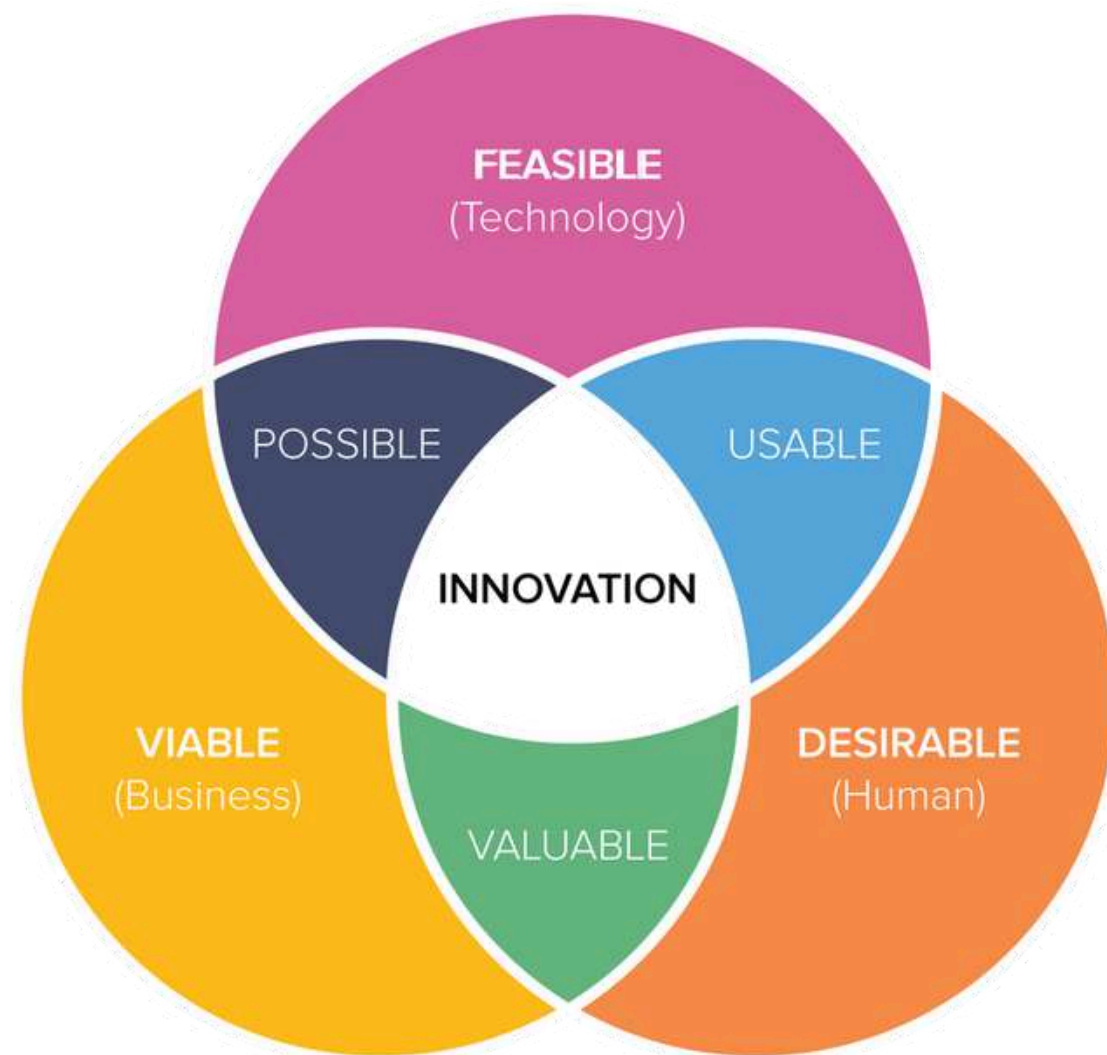
Ideation



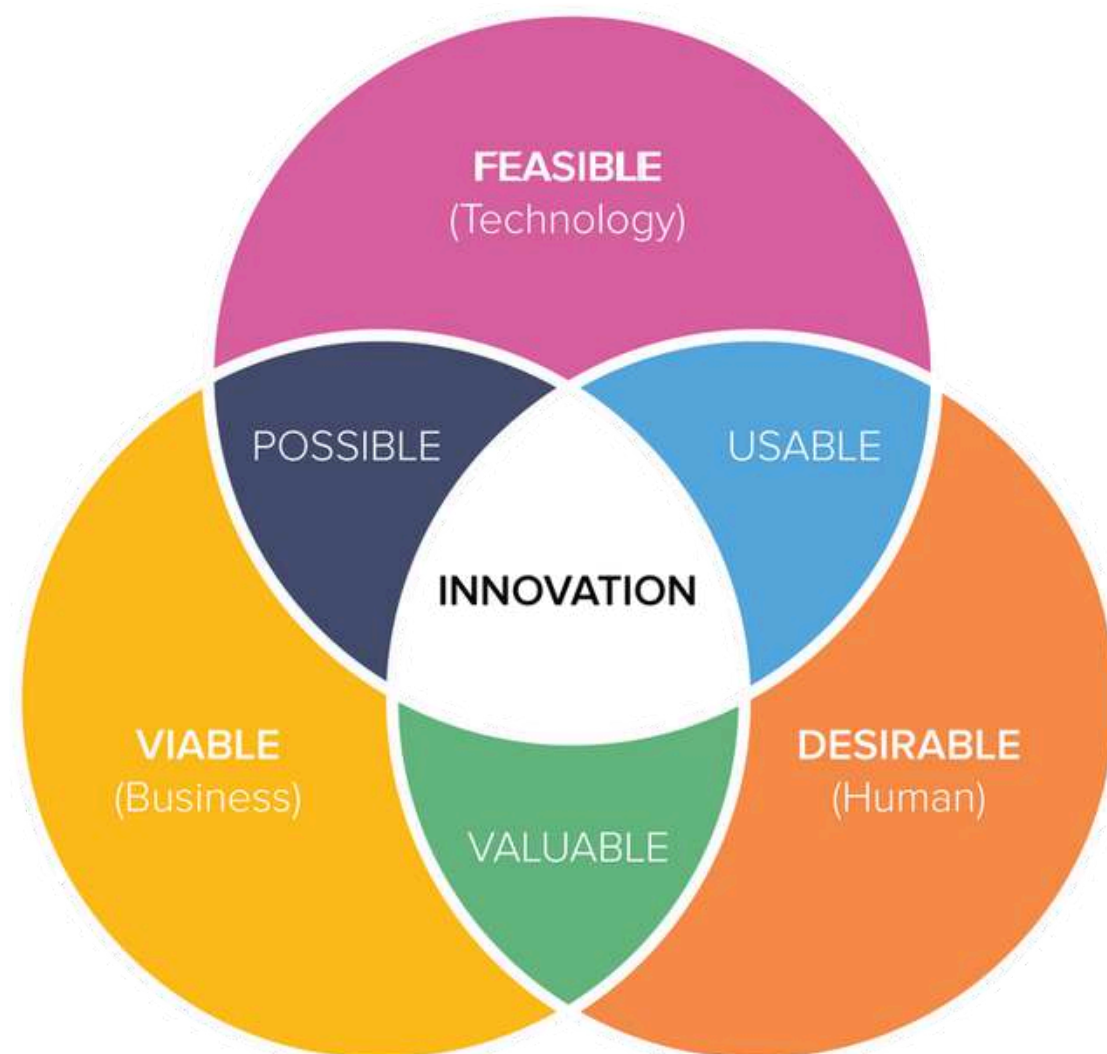
Choosing the right business idea is a mixture of personal drive, market need, and technological feasibility.



Ideation



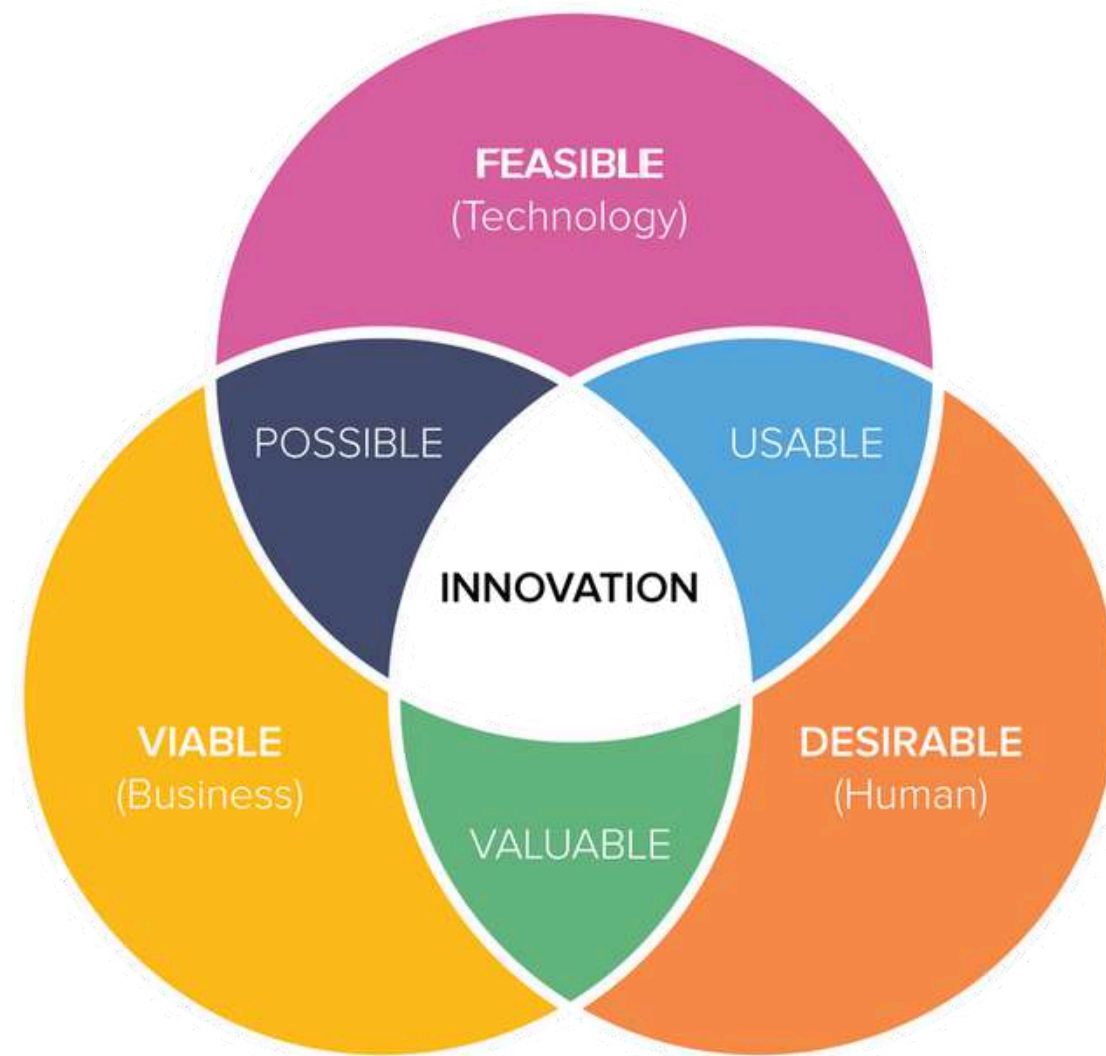
Ideation



The MessagePad Newton was the iPhone a decade too early.

Why?

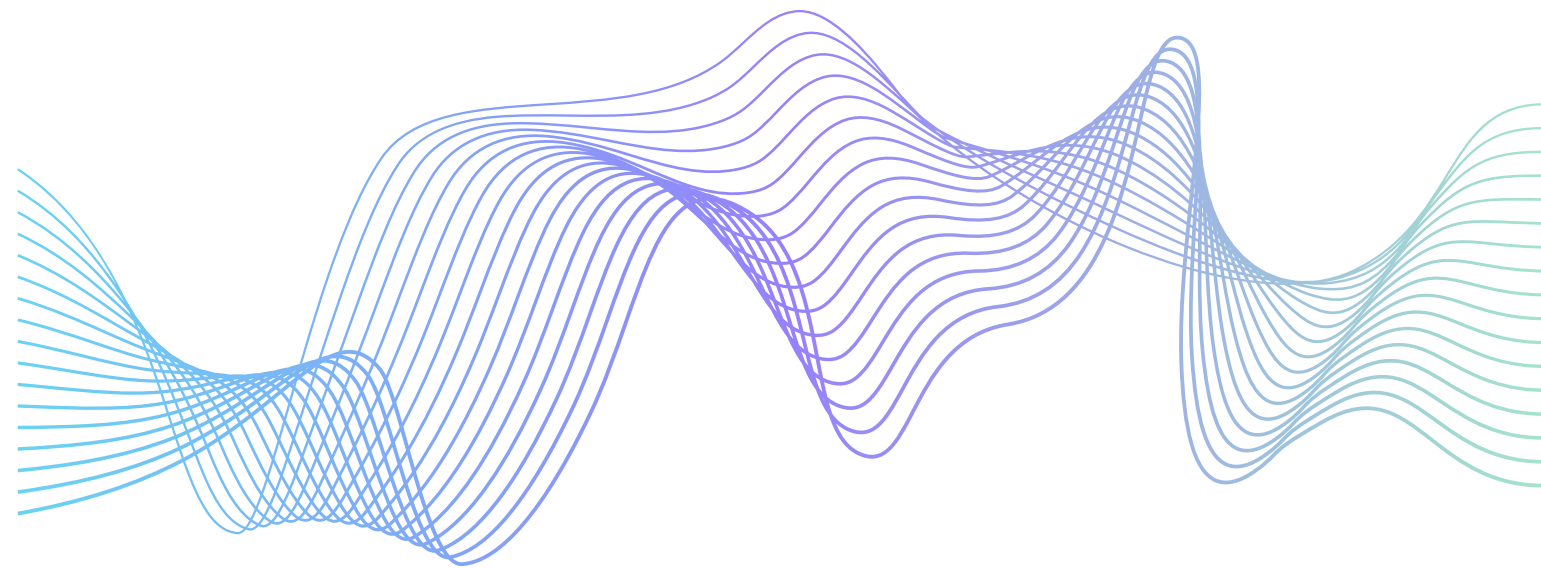
Ideation



- Battery technology was primitive, with early models sucking triple-A batteries dry in the blink of an eye
- Capacitive touchscreens were many years away.
- Wireless connectivity and mobile broadband were yet to deliver on their promises.

Number one reason –
“Building something
nobody wants”



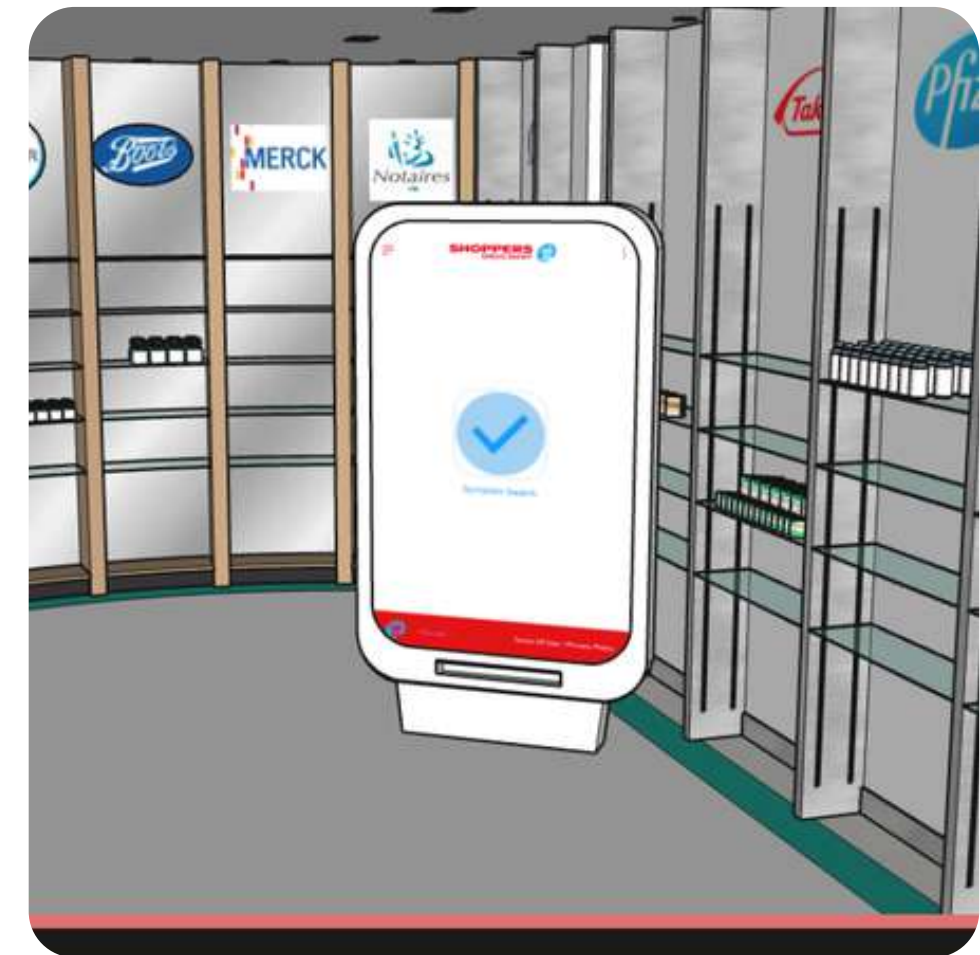


2017

- Identified customer problems that could have been solved with technology, but what next?

MedaKi

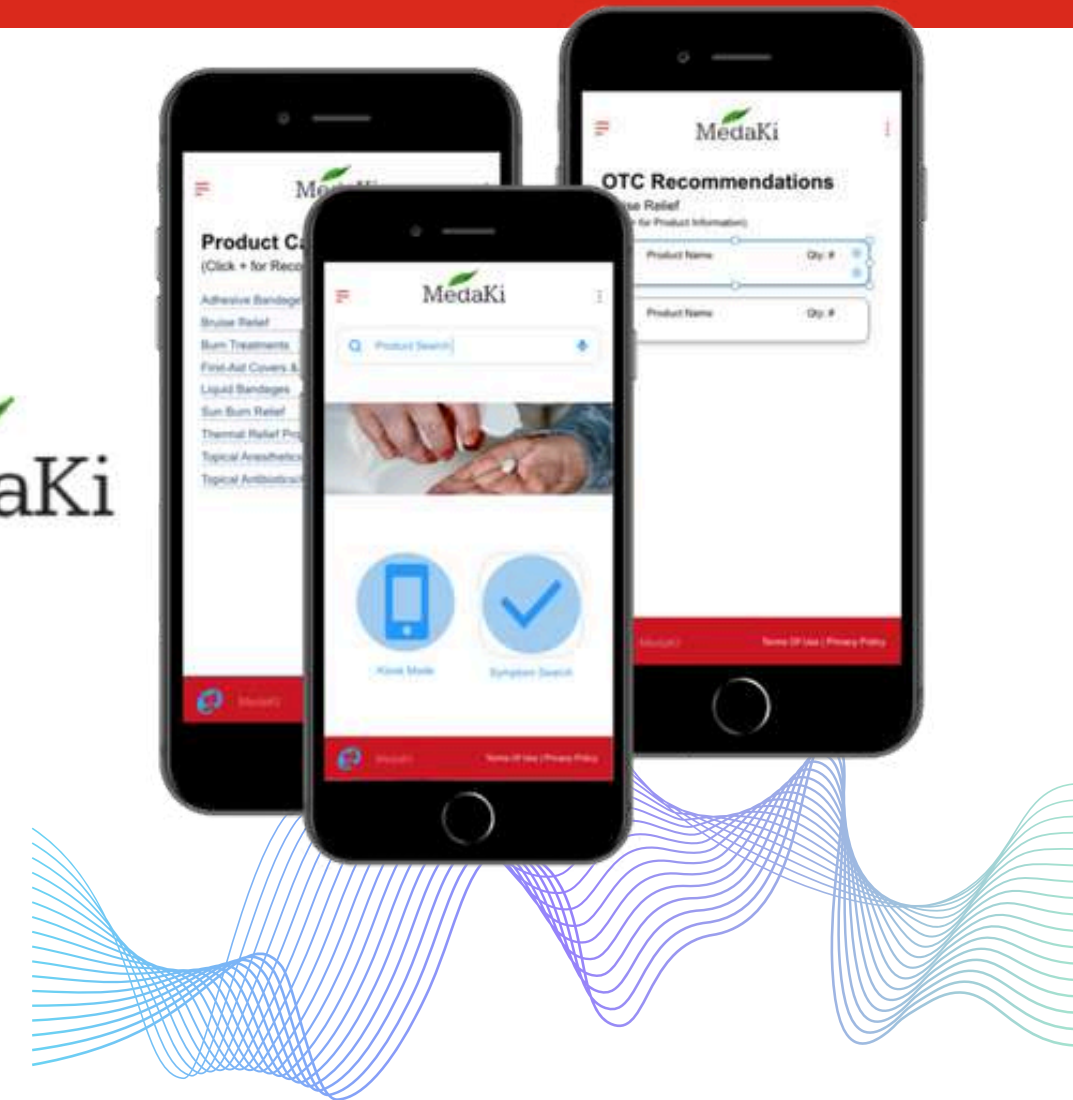
The Pharmacy Assistant Kiosk



- Learnt about the start-up ecosystem and **what I had missed out on**

- Tech student developing a pharmacy app. **What am I missing?**

MedaKi



Tarek Hussein,
Independent Pharmacy Owner at



WELLER PHARMACY
Service you need from neighbours you trust!

**But how can you
find a industry
expert?**

(we also pivoted)

Benefits:

- Receive Feedback
- Pilot and beta launch
- Introductions to other customers
- Connections in the industry (partnerships)

How to find a
Industry Expert.

Seneca HELIX
POLYTECHNIC

MARKHAM
BOARD OF TRADE

Linked 

- Leverage your connections
- Cold outreach

**How to
communicate with
non-industry
individuals**

Which one is better suited for a elevator pitch?

MedaKi streamlines workflows inside pharmacies to solve inefficiencies by leveraging the latest technologies. We have developed seamless SAAS solutions that help pharmacies develop an online store to easily sell to their customers and host our platform on AWS for PHIPA and PIPEDA compliance.

OR

MedaKi helps pharmacies setup their own eCommerce store in less than 10 minutes.

**How to
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OR

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How can you come
up with ideas?

**First, select your industry,
then ASK QUESTIONS!**

First, select your industry!

What program are you in? Is there a topic that interests you? Books? Collectibles? Do you have a hobby? Are you passionate about fighting climate change?

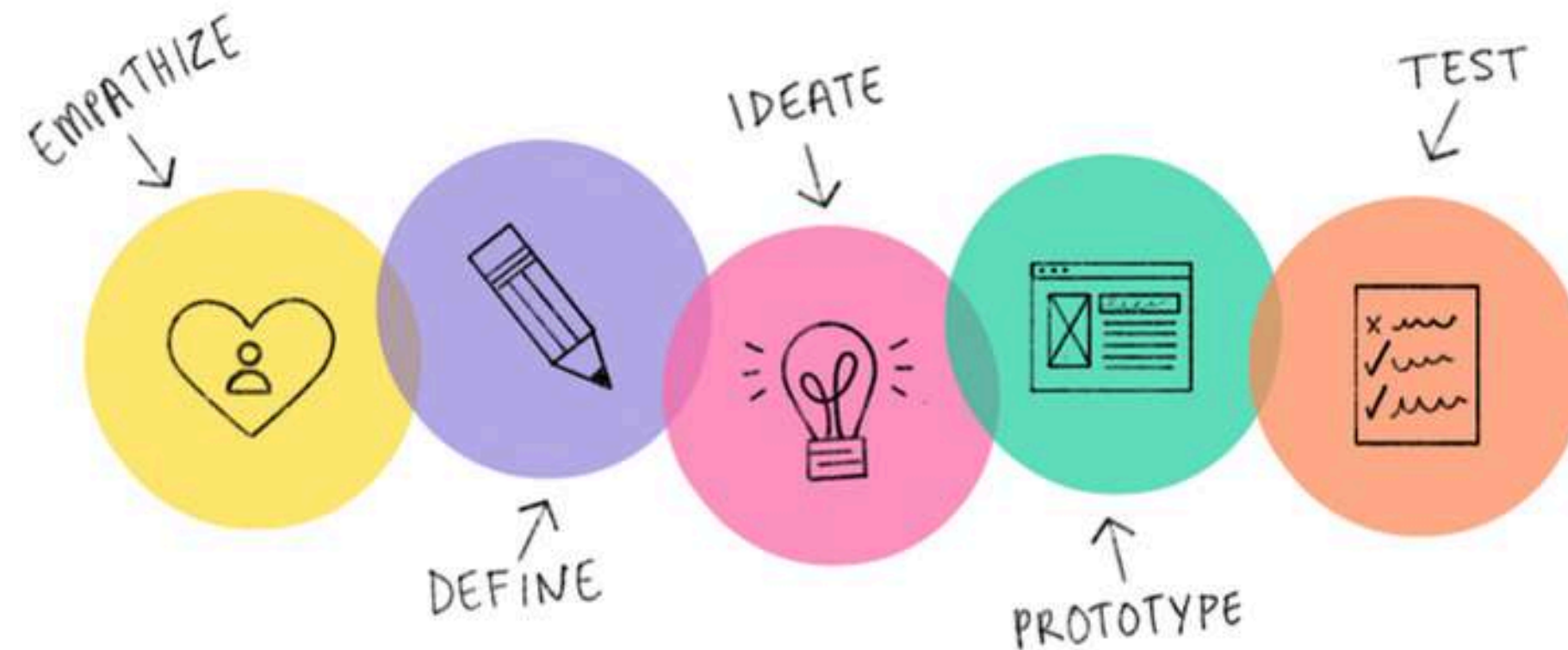
What experiences do you have? Have you faced a problem you would like to solve?

Then, ASK QUESTIONS!

What challenges do you face? How can you improve your services or operations? What is your greatest pain point? If you could change one thing, what would it be?

Identify a problem you want to find a solution for.

Use design thinking!

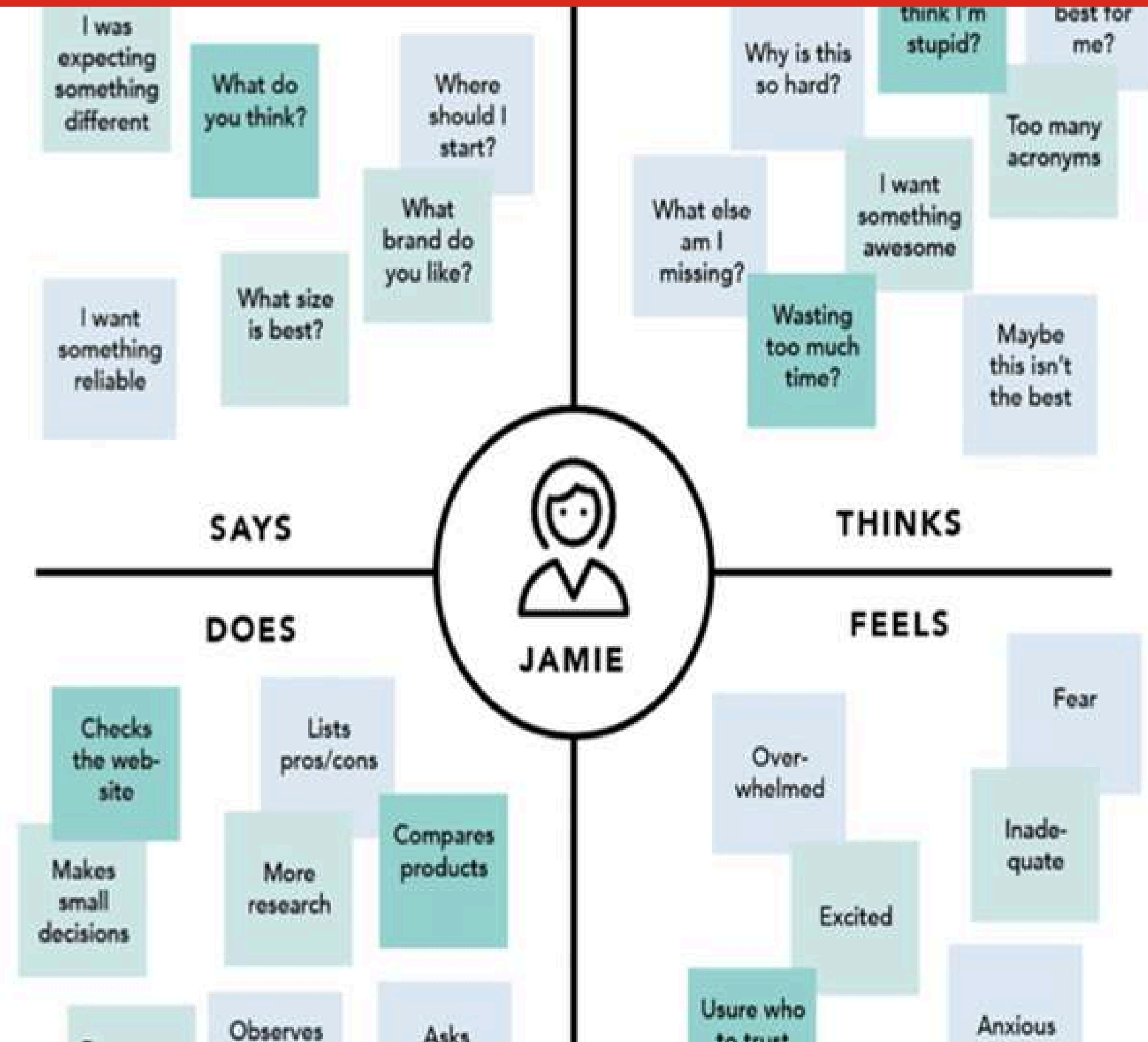


Design Thinking is a human-centered approach to innovation. It is a process for creative problem solving” -Tim Brown CEO IDEO

Ideation

Talk to those that are affected by the problem to understand their pain and challenges.

Be empathetic and non-judgmental.



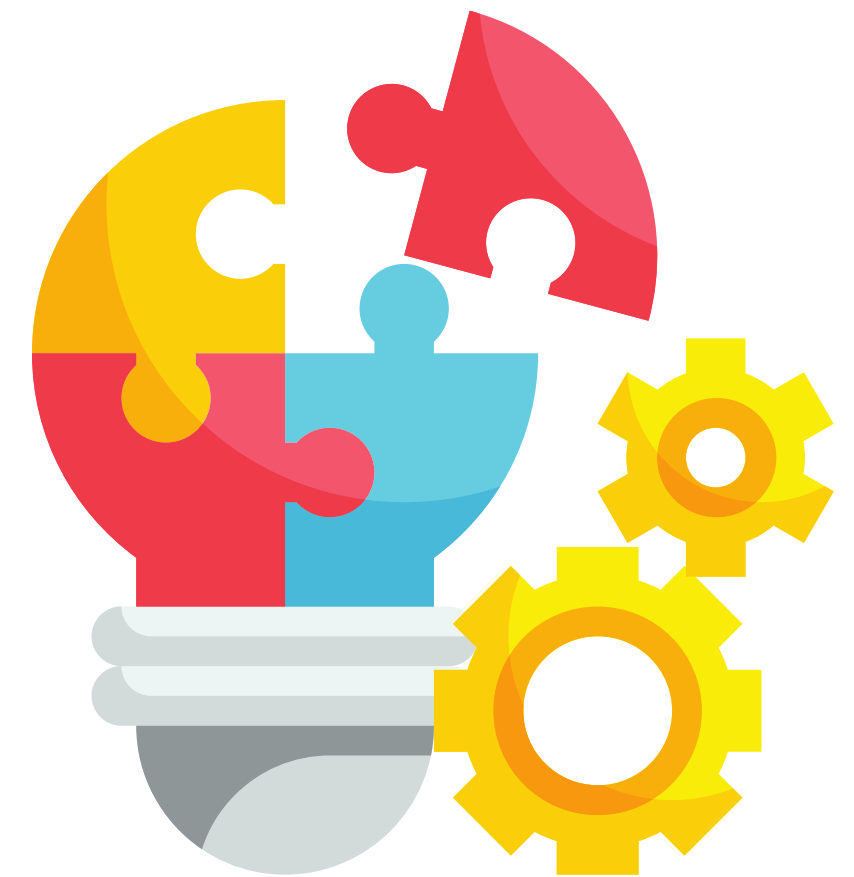
Reframe the problem statement that you are trying to solve.

Who is experiencing the problem/pain?

How many experience the problem/pain?

What is the frequency of problem/pain?

Is the problem/pain serious enough for people to pay to get rid of them?



The Formula

Strive to identify the problems & pains that are most relevant to the people affected.

Provide evidence that the people affected care about your solution.

What can you do to get answers?



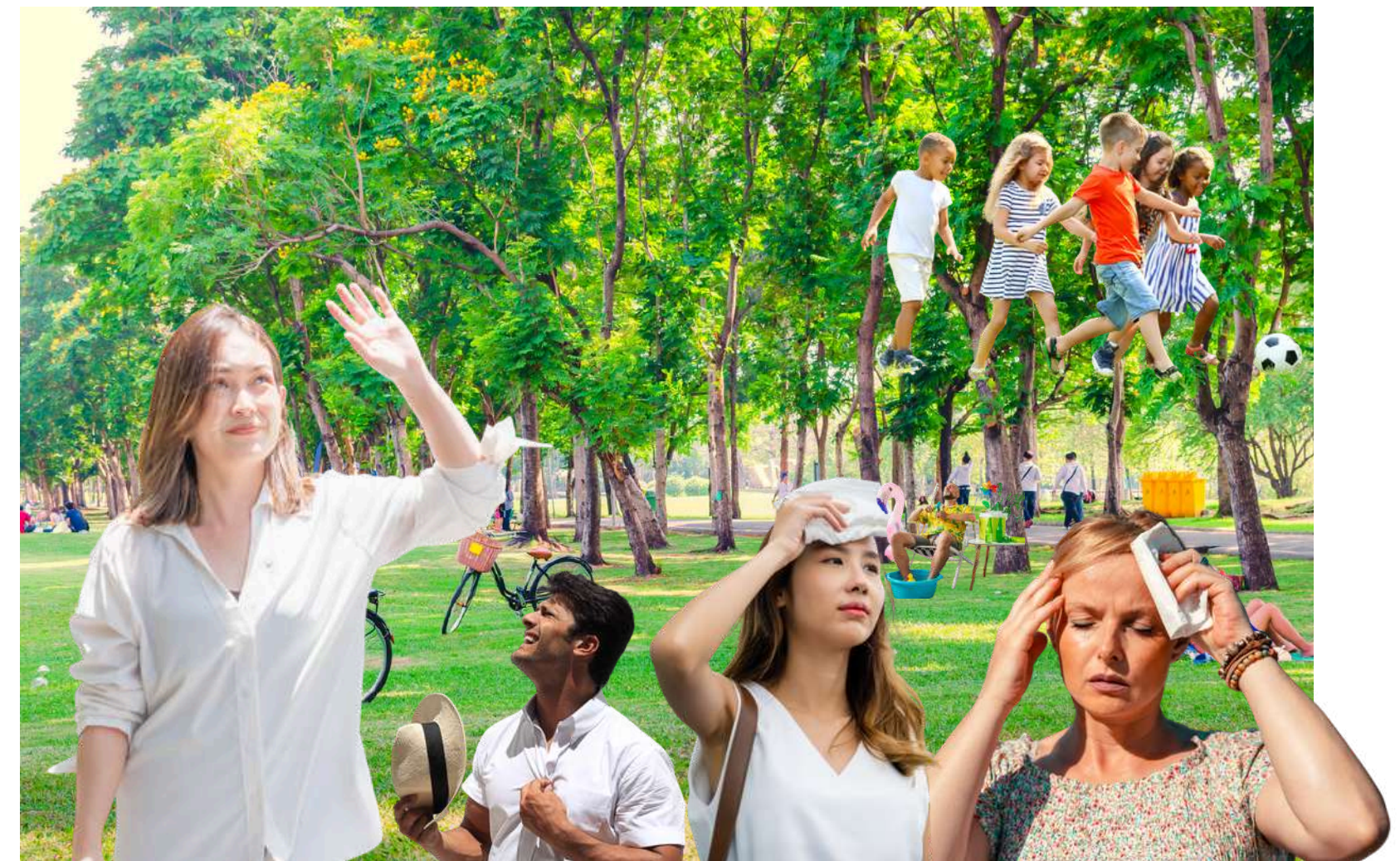


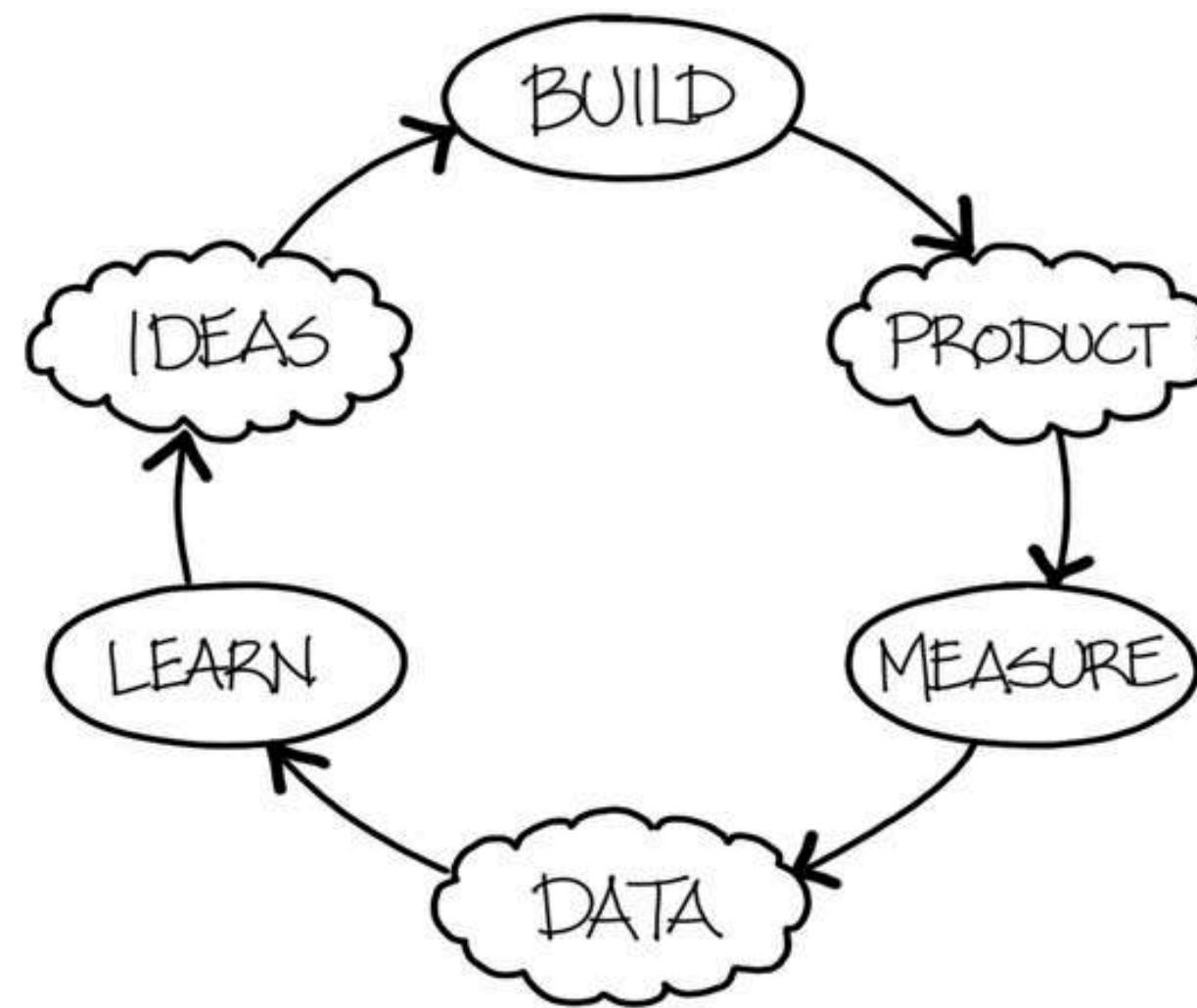
Hot Summer Day at High Park - 5 Min Class Activity

Identify different problems to address.

List the people affected by the problems.

Identify various ideas for solutions that you can monetize.





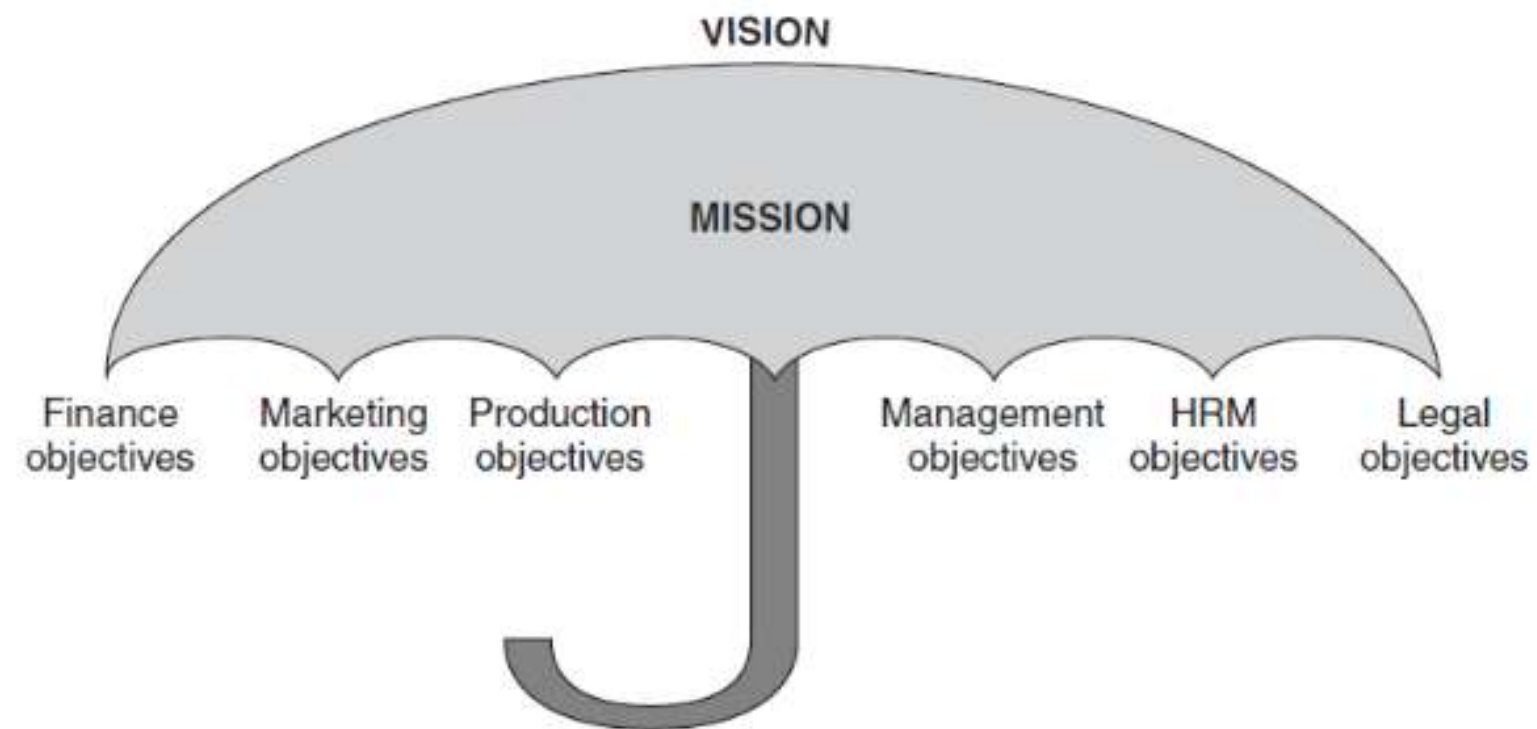
Vision

Explains what the business is stressing to become in the future.

Mission Statement

Defines the present business scope and broadly describes the organization's present capabilities, focus, and activities.

Strategic Umbrella



1. Identify 5 successful entrepreneurs in your field of study or business industry that you find inspiring. Describe their success story, how they found their business idea, and what made their business stand out to you. (Min. 200 words each)
2. Identify 5 start-ups that have recently raised funds in your field of study or business industry. Describe their success story, what they raised funds for, and their mission and vision. (Min. 200 words each)
3. Find 5 news articles about a problem in your field of study/business industry/related to your idea. Explain the problem in your own words. (Min. 200 words each)

Create a Word doc/PDF for your submission.

Form Your Problem Statement

For (user persona), who is facing (problem or challenge), the current solutions (limitations of existing solutions, if applicable).

How might we (desired outcome or goal) so that (impact or benefit)?

Include in the word doc/pdf in your submission.

HELIX INNOVATION STRAND WORKBOOK

IDEATION

IDEATION **LEARNING OUTCOMES**

**Empathize and
define problems**



**Create ideas for
solving the problems**

IDEATION **PROCESS**



IDEATION PROCESS



? What problem do you want to solve?

A large, empty, rounded rectangular box intended for writing or drawing.

IDEATION PROCESS



? Problem Identified !

Who does the problem effect?

Who does the problem effect?

Who does the problem effect?

(You can write up to 14 lines in each box)

IDEATION PROCESS



? Problem Identified !

Group 1

How is group 1 effected?

Group 2

How is group 2 effected?

Group 3

How is group 3 effected?

IDEATION **RESOURCES**



Design Thinking



Stanford D.School



Government of Canada COVID-19 Challenges



Golden Rules of Ideation

HELIX INNOVATION IDEATION
STRAND WORKBOOK

DUE NEXT WEEK ON MONDAY AT 11:59 PM